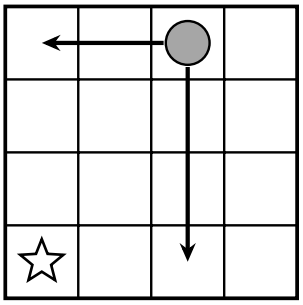
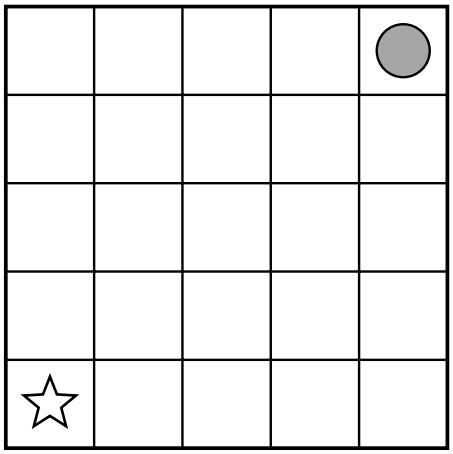
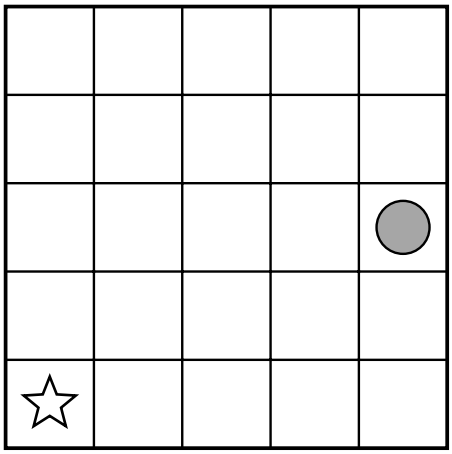
Players take turns. On a board, a move slides the token straight left or straight down, toward the star's side, one or more squares. Whoever moves the token onto the star wins.

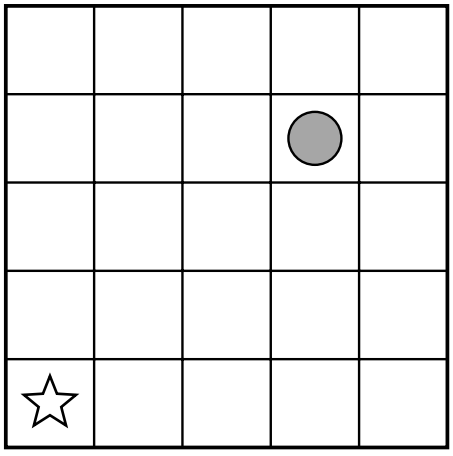


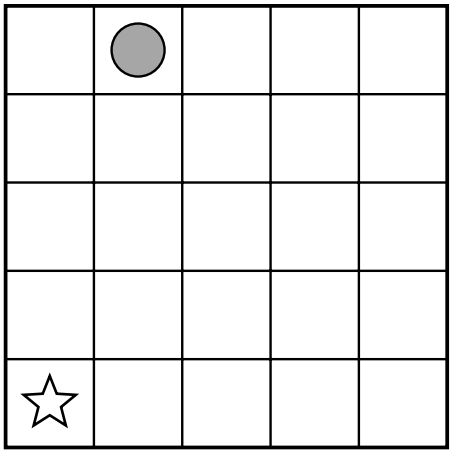
In a game with piles of counters, a move takes one or more counters from one pile. Whoever takes the last counter wins.

Problem 1: Play many games on a 5-by-5 board from each of these starting squares. Would you rather go first or second?

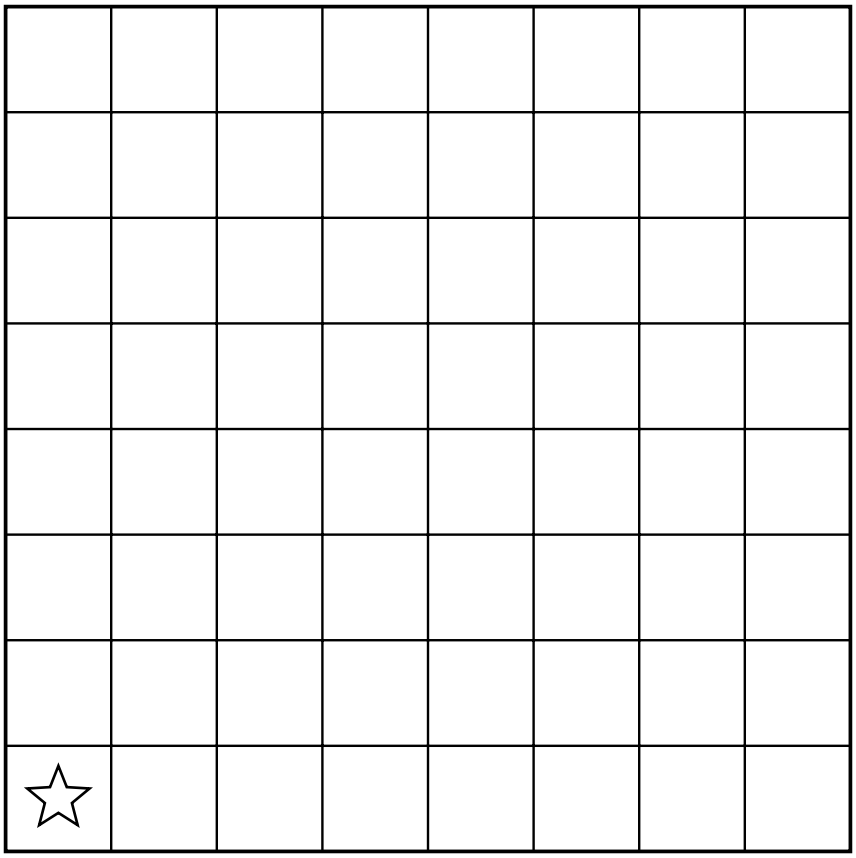




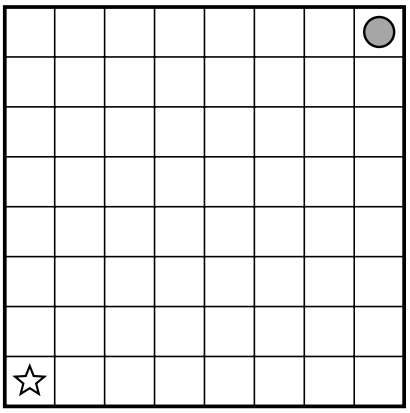




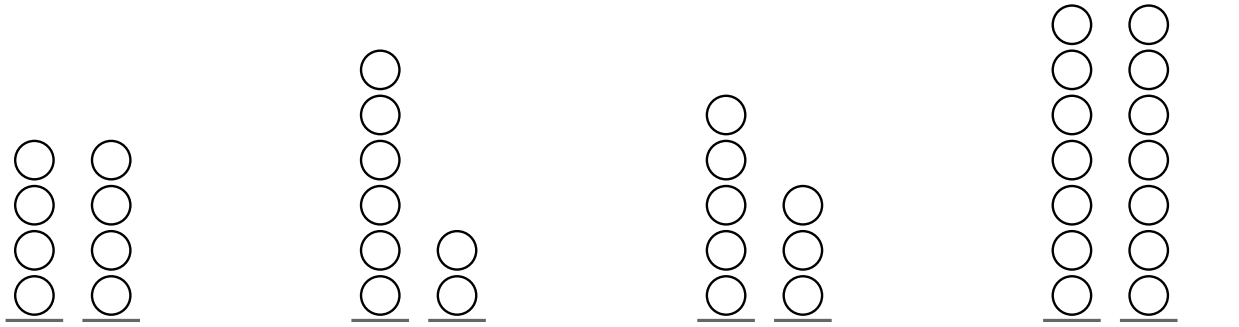
Problem 2: Color every square of this 8-by-8 board except the star. Color a square green if you would rather go first when the token starts there, and red if you would rather go second.

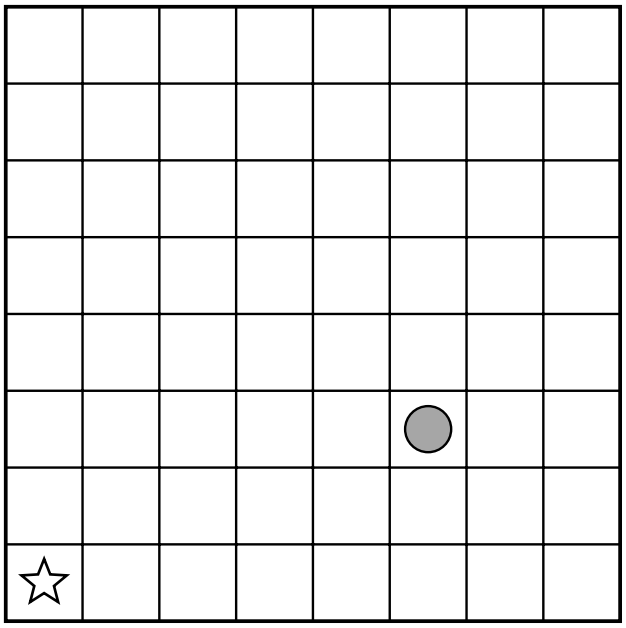


Problem 3: Your partner goes first, with the token in the top-right corner of an 8-by-8 board. Explain how you can always win, however your partner moves.



Problem 4: Play many games with two piles of counters from each start. Would you rather go first or second?



4 and 4 | 6 and 2 | 5 and 3 | 7 and 7

Problem 5: Which two piles of counters make the same game as this 8-by-8 board with the token on the dot? Explain how each move on the board matches a move with the piles.